Institution: Royal Ontario Museum
Registration Number: 910X255.24
Fabric: Rhodian ceramic
Shape: Transport amphora handle fragment with impressed rectangular stamp
Attribution: Rhodian workshop (unidentified)
Date: Hellenistic, c. 323 BC to 30 BC
Dimensions: W. 7.3; H.4.4 cm
Provenance: Unknown

Fabric, Technique, Shape & Condition
Fragment of a ceramic transport amphora handle, preserving part of the attachment and a rectangular stamp impressed prior to firing. The clay is pink-reddish yellow. The fragment is broken along all edges, with the handle section partially preserved. The stamped surface remains legible, though worn, with minor abrasions particularly on the lower right. Abrasions affects the clarity of the impression, though the stamped writing is still legible. No traces of surface decoration or glaze are present.

Iconography The fragment preserves a rectangular stamp impressed on the upper face of the handle prior to firing (Fig.1). The stamp bears a three-line Greek inscription reading ΕΠΙ ΑΡΙΣΤΟ/ ΓΕΙΤΟΥ/ΔΑΛΙΟΥ, following the standard Rhodian eponym stamp formula in which ΕΠΙ + genitive records the name of the annually appointed eponym priest of Helios under whose authority the vessel was produced.[1]

Fig. 1. Fragment of a transport amphora handle with impressed rectangular stamp, Hellenistic, 3rd–2nd century BCE. Royal Ontario Museum, Toronto, acc. no. 910X255.24. © Royal Ontario Museum.

The second term, ΔΑΛΙΟΥ, is the genitive of Δάλιος, a month in the Rhodian calendar, which indicates the production period within the eponym's term.[2] Such eponym stamps are of particular importance for the chronology of Rhodian amphorae and the commercial contexts in which they were distributed.[3] No figural or symbolic devices are visible on the stamp, though a rose, the civic emblem of Rhodes, commonly appears on comparable examples. No surface

---

[1] Grace, Virginia R. "The Eponyms Named on Rhodian Amphora Stamps." *Hesperia* 22, no. 2 (1953): 116–128. https://www.ascsa.edu.gr/uploads/media/hesperia/146986.pdf; Royal Ontario Museum. "Fragment of an Amphora Handle with Rectangular Stamp." Collection object 910X255.24. https://collections.rom.on.ca/objects/376495/fragment-of-an-amphora-handle-with-rectangular-stamp-eiapi.

[2] Alkaç, Erkan. "Rhodian Amphora Stamps from the Cappadocia Güray Museum." *Akdeniz İnsani Bilimler Dergisi* XIV (2024): 303–310. https://dergipark.org.tr/tr/download/article-file/3896013; British Museum. "Transport Amphora." Collection object G_1925-0119-58. https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/object/G_1925-0119-58.

[3] Lund, John. Review of *Lexicon of Eponym Dies on Rhodian Amphora Stamps*, by G. Cankardeş-Şenol. *American Journal of Archaeology* 123, no. 4 (October 2019). https://ajaonline.org/book-review/3967.

decoration or glaze is present on the fragment.

Fig. 2. Rhodian transport amphora (left) with detail of stamped handle (right), Hellenistic. British Museum, London, acc. no. 1868,0705.167. © The Trustees of the British Museum.

Attribution & Dating Attributed to a Rhodian amphora production center on the basis of the stamp formula and epigraphic conventions. The ΕΠΙ + eponym genitive construction is characteristic of Rhodian stamping practice, in which the annually appointed priest of Helios served as the administrative authority under whose term vessels were produced, certified, and exported, particularly for wine. The additional month name ΔΑΛΙΟΥ further refines the production date within that term, a feature attested on securely identified Rhodian stamps such as those in the Cappadocia Güray Museum, where the same eponym-plus-month formula is preserved and dated to approximately 185 BCE.[4] The stamp structure, rectangular format, and three-line inscription of the ROM fragment are consistent with established Rhodian examples across the Hellenistic period.[5] The eponym name Aristogeiton is attested in Grace's catalogue of known Rhodian magistrates, confirming the Rhodian origin of the stamp.[6] A comparable Rhodian transport amphora at the British Museum (1868,0705.167) preserves stamped handles at the handle-neck junction and illustrates the complete vessel form to which a fragment like this would have originally belonged (Fig.2). A date in the 3rd – 2nd century BCE is therefore supported, with the presence of a month designation suggesting the later end of that range when the practice became more common.

[4] Özyıldırım, Ufuk. "Rhodian Amphora Stamps in the Cappadocia Güray Museum." *Dergipark* (2024). https://dergipark.org.tr/tr/download/article-file/3896013.

[5] Lund, John. Review of *Lexicon of Eponym Dies on Rhodian Amphora Stamps*, by G. Cankardeş-Şenol. *American Journal of Archaeology* 123, no. 4 (October 2019). https://ajaonline.org/book-review/3967.

[6] Grace, Virginia R. "The Eponyms Named on Rhodian Amphora Stamps." *Hesperia* 22, no. 2 (1953): 116–128. https://www.ascsa.edu.gr/uploads/media/hesperia/146986.pdf.

Works Cited

Alkaç, Erkan. "Rhodian Amphora Stamps from the Cappadocia Güray Museum." *Akdeniz İnsani Bilimler Dergisi* XIV (2024): 303–310. https://dergipark.org.tr/tr/download/article-file/3896013.

Australian National University, Classics Museum. "Rhodian Amphora Handle." Catalogue object 1970.06. ANU Classics Museum Collection. https://slll.cass.anu.edu.au/classics-museum/catalogue/objects/rhodian-amphora-handle-197006.

British Museum. "Transport Amphora." Collection object 1868,0705.167. https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/object/G_1868-0705-167.

Grace, Virginia R. "The Eponyms Named on Rhodian Amphora Stamps." *Hesperia* 22, no. 2 (1953): 116–128. https://www.ascsa.edu.gr/uploads/media/hesperia/146986.pdf.

Lund, John. Review of *Lexicon of Eponym Dies on Rhodian Amphora Stamps*, by G. Cankardeş-Şenol. *American Journal of Archaeology* 123, no. 4 (October 2019). https://ajaonline.org/book-review/3967.

Özyıldırım, Ufuk. "Rhodian Amphora Stamps in the Cappadocia Güray Museum." *Dergipark* (2024). https://dergipark.org.tr/tr/download/article-file/3896013.

Rhodian Stamped Amphorae: Emergence of Globalization." ArcGIS StoryMaps. Accessed April 3, 2026. https://storymaps.arcgis.com/stories/515e835af40848ed8749fafb438c121c.

Royal Ontario Museum. "Fragment of an Amphora Handle with Rectangular Stamp." Collection object 910X255.24. https://collections.rom.on.ca/objects/376495/fragment-of-an-amphora-handle-with-rectangular-stamp-eiapi.